

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION

Sole Source (Including Brand Name) Justification - Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items

NOTE: If a Justification was approved for the preceding acquisition, a copy of the approved Justification for the predecessor action must be included in the staff package for approval of the instant Justification. This applies to Justification staff packages that are submitted for review and approval at a level above the contracting officer. The predecessor Justification will be used as a reference document by the approving official.

Is this a new or amended J&A Document? ☒ New ☐ Amended (Prior to Award Only!)

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Funding level for this acquisition:

AFSC/PZIMA

Contracting Activity: 3001 Staff Dr.

Tinker AFB, OK 73145

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: H6TC19

Program / Project (and PE, if applicable): Range Array Test Set (RATS) Upgrade

Program Type (PEO or Other Contracting): Other Contracting

Authority: ☒ DAFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3572, Implementation of Simplified Acquisition Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901)

☐ DAFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3403, Special Emergency Procurement Authority (41 U.S.C. 1903)

Estimated Contract Cost (including options):

Justification Type: ☐ Class ☒ Individual

COORDINATION ([DAFFARS 5306.304\(a\)](#))

Date

05 Jan 2026

[APPROVAL \(DAFFARS 5306.304\(a\)\)](#)

Date

06 Jan 2026

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I. Contracting Activity.

United States Air Force (USAF), Air Force Sustainment Center, Maintenance Contracting Branch (AFSC/PZIMA - Tinker), 3001 Staff Dr, Tinker AFB, OK 73145

II. Nature and/or description of the action being processed.

The 76 CMXG requires a sole-source contract for upgrading the Range Array Test Set (RATS) Radio Frequency (RF) equipment and accessories. The RATS equipment is used for testing B-1 Low Observable Antenna (LOA) at various stages in the repair process as designated in the applicable technical documents. The intent of this requirement is to upgrade the RF portions of the equipment within [REDACTED] on Tinker Air Force Base. The test stand console will remain in place, with only RF equipments being replaced.

The original RATS equipment was installed in 1990 and manufactured by Westinghouse and Scientific Atlanta. The equipment was upgraded in 2016 by NSI-MI (formerly Scientific Atlanta), along with Northrop Grumman (formerly Westinghouse). [REDACTED]

This requirement requires the contractor to upgrade [REDACTED] equipment and workstation computer/software. The contractor will also be required to provide support to Northrop Grumman for updates that may involved shared equipment.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs.

New MI-3001 Workstation with the latest software (Windows 11), ELE-VFA-S11 receiver, ELE-SRC-DS-0.01-20 Transmit Source, ELE-MIX-1-26.5 Mixers (quantity of 4), Adapter cables from VFA to Existing Multiplexer Control Cables (Quantity 2), Modifications to the 4 RF plates/assemblies for new Mixers, Program Management and Engineering Services, Remote kick-off meeting, 1 design review, 3-day remote support for Northrop Grumman, Factory Integration and test, on-site installation, test, acceptance and training, Replace 2-port MUX with ELE-MUX-2C-0.1-20, replace 4-port MUX with equivalent, on-site installation and Test, on-site support to Northrop Grumman for 1 week (labor and travel).

IV. Statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition.

DAFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3572, Implementation of Simplified Acquisition Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901)

V. Demonstration that the contractor's unique qualifications or nature of the acquisition requires the use of the authority cited above (applicability of authority).

This sole source acquisition is required due to proprietary data for required software and interoperability with existing systems. The required software is called out within TO 12P1-4-30-8-4 and per AFSC Manual 21-102, Depot Maintenance Management, Para. 1.3: "AF TOs are published under the authority of the Secretary of the Air Force (SECAF). Compliance with TOs is mandatory."

Ametek NSI-MI is the OEM for the MI-710-C and MI-3000 software and retains proprietary rights to both pieces of software. No other vendors exist for these items. NSI-MI is also the OEM for the system being upgraded and retains all necessary information needed for operation and implementation of the new test equipment. Ametek NSI-MI implemented the original test equipment and has proven to have all necessary knowledge, experience and security clearances required for the project.

For a new company to enter the bidding process, it would require knowledge of the B-1 Low Observable Antenna, Range Array Test Set, and RF equipment along with access to the necessary software that is proprietary to Ametek NSI-MI. Ametek NSI-MI has stated that there is no interest in providing another company rights to their customized software.

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VI. Description of efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable.

Due to proprietary rights for the required software, Ametek NSI-MI had confirmed that no other vendors have access to the proprietary software.

VII. Determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The Contracting Officer will utilize FAR 12.203 to ensure the price is fair and reasonable.

VIII. Description of the market research conducted and the results, or a statement of the reasons market research was not conducted.

Due to the proprietary software, market research had consisted that Ametek NSI-MI remains the only source with proprietary rights, along with the necessary historical knowledge of equipment operation and testing requirements.

IX. Any other facts supporting the use of Other Than Full and Open Competition.

No new information.

X. List of any sources that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

Ametek NSI-MI
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Suwanee, GA 30024
CAGE: 1CDY6

XI. A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before making subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required.

The Air Force has exhausted all options to foster competition for test stands that have the capability of upgrading RF equipment. With the restriction of the software and only one company holding proprietary rights the choices are severely limited.

XII. Certification by the Contracting Officer.

As evidenced by my signature above, I have determined this document to be both accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

XIII. Certification by the technical/requirements personnel.

As evidenced by my signature above, I certify that any supporting data contained herein, which is my responsibility, is both accurate and complete.